

OppNet: A Platform helping college students find Internship and Freelance Work

Submitted in partial fulfillment of the requirements of

Third Year

in

Computer Engineering

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(AY 2025-26)

CERTIFICATE

This is to certify that the Mini Project 2B entitled “ **OppNet: A Platform helping college students find Internship and Freelance Work** ” is a bonafide work of Sahil Desai(65), Abhishek Jadhav(69), Nandini Jadhav(70), Sahil Jadhav(71) submitted to the University of Mumbai in partial fulfillment of the requirement for the award of the degree of “**Third year of Engineering**” in “**Computer Engineering**”.

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This Mini Project entitled “ **OppNet: A Platform helping college students find Internship and Freelance Work** ” by **Sahil Desai(65), Abhishek Jadhav(69), Nandini Jadhav(70), Sahil Jadhav(71)** is approved for the degree of “**Third year of Engineering**” in “**Computer Engineering**”.

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ABSTRACT:

The Freelance and Internship Platform is a unified web-based system that integrates two key domains: freelancing and academic internships. Existing portals function in isolation, with freelancing platforms such as Upwork and Fiverr catering to professionals, and internship portals such as Internshala serving students. This separation forces users to rely on multiple systems, leading to inefficiency and lack of transparency. The proposed platform addresses this gap by providing a centralized solution where students, freelancers, organizations, and administrators can collaborate seamlessly.

The platform features role-based dashboards, secure authentication, project and internship posting, real-time communication, application tracking, and analytics for performance evaluation. It is developed using a three-tier architecture, with a responsive frontend (HTML, CSS, JavaScript/React.js), a robust backend (Node.js/Django), and a scalable database (MySQL/MongoDB). Security and usability are enhanced through authentication APIs, encryption mechanisms, and administrator monitoring.

The project not only benefits students by simplifying internship discovery and progress tracking but also supports freelancers in portfolio building and professional growth. Organizations gain efficiency in recruitment and monitoring, while administrators ensure transparency and quality. Overall, this system bridges the gap between academia and industry, creating a practical and scalable solution for both academic and professional ecosystems.

List of Abbreviations

UI – User Interface
API – Application Programming Interface
DBMS – Database Management System
SQL – Structured Query Language
HTML – Hypertext Markup Language
CSS – Cascading Style Sheets
UML – Unified Modeling Language

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Flowchart
User flow diagram

Chapter 1 Introduction

1.1 Introduction

In today's rapidly evolving digital era, freelancing and internships have emerged as vital components of professional and academic growth. With the increasing demand for practical skills and real-world experience, students and professionals alike are seeking flexible opportunities that enhance their learning, employability, and overall career development. Internships serve as a bridge between theoretical education and industrial practice, allowing students to apply classroom knowledge in real-world scenarios, gain industry exposure, and build professional networks. On the other hand, freelancing empowers individuals to work independently, explore multiple domains, and develop entrepreneurial and time management skills while contributing to diverse projects across industries and geographies.

Despite the growing importance of both freelancing and internships, the platforms supporting these opportunities remain largely fragmented. Existing internship portals are often limited to students and academic institutions, focusing primarily on structured training programs and campus recruitments. Meanwhile, freelancing platforms are tailored to experienced professionals, emphasizing client-based work and payment systems rather than learning or mentorship. This separation leads to inefficiencies such as redundant registrations, limited opportunity discovery, poor communication between stakeholders, and a lack of unified progress tracking. As a result, students who wish to explore freelancing alongside their academic pursuits often face difficulties navigating multiple systems, while organizations struggle to manage interns and freelancers through different channels.

To overcome these limitations, the proposed **Freelance and Internship Platform** aims to integrate both functionalities within a single, centralized solution. The platform will offer distinct yet interconnected dashboards for students, freelancers, mentors, and employers, ensuring a seamless experience for all users. It will feature secure authentication, project and task management modules, real-time communication tools, and progress analytics to monitor performance and outcomes. The system's architecture will be designed for scalability and usability, supporting both short-term freelance projects and structured internship programs. Furthermore, by combining these domains, the platform encourages collaboration between academia and industry, enabling educational institutions to track student performance while helping organizations discover and evaluate emerging talent.

This integrated approach not only simplifies access to opportunities but also bridges the gap between academic learning and industry application. It fosters a culture of continuous learning, flexibility, and innovation, equipping users with the necessary skills to thrive in the digital economy. Ultimately, the proposed platform serves as a comprehensive ecosystem that promotes professional growth, enhances employability, and streamlines the overall process of engagement between students, freelancers, and organizations.

1.2 Motivation

The motivation behind this project stems from the challenges faced by students, freelancers, and organizations in accessing and managing opportunities effectively. In the current digital environment, students often struggle to find verified internships that match their academic goals. Many face difficulties in managing internship progress, maintaining communication with mentors, and gaining structured feedback that contributes to skill development and career readiness.

Freelancers, particularly beginners, encounter similar challenges on existing platforms. Websites such as Upwork and Fiverr cater mainly to experienced professionals and charge high service fees. New freelancers find it difficult to build portfolios, manage client communication, and track project milestones efficiently. The absence of integrated collaboration and progress-tracking tools limits their growth and reduces the transparency needed to establish trust with clients.

Organizations also face inefficiencies in recruitment and project monitoring. Employers spend significant time posting opportunities, screening applications, and manually tracking candidate performance across multiple platforms. This lack of integration leads to delays, miscommunication, and reduced productivity in managing internships and freelance engagements.

To address these issues, the proposed **Freelance and Internship Platform** integrates all stakeholders into a single system. It enables students to find and manage verified internships, freelancers to handle projects effectively, and organizations to recruit and monitor candidates efficiently. The inclusion of dashboards, analytics, and communication tools enhances transparency, motivation, and accountability. Ultimately, this platform aims to create a unified ecosystem that bridges the gap between academia and industry while promoting professional growth and collaboration.

1.3 Problem Statement and Objectives

Problem Statement: Existing freelancing and internship platforms function separately, causing inefficiency and lack of transparency. Students, freelancers, and organizations face challenges in communication, application tracking, and performance monitoring. There is a need for a unified platform that integrates freelancing and internships with role-based dashboards, communication tools, and analytics.

Objectives:

- To design and develop a unified Freelance and Internship Platform.
- To provide role-based dashboards for students, freelancers, organizations, and administrators.
- To enable secure authentication, project posting, and application tracking.
- To support real-time communication between users and organizations.
- To incorporate analytics and reporting for performance evaluation.
- To ensure security, scalability, and transparency.

Chapter 2 Literature Survey

2.1 Survey of Existing System

Several platforms currently address freelancing and internship needs, but each operates within a limited scope and fails to provide a comprehensive solution. **Freelancing portals** such as *Upwork*, *Fiverr*, and *Freelancer* primarily connect professionals with clients for short-term projects. While these platforms offer global exposure and diverse opportunities, they often impose **high service fees** and lack **beginner-friendly tools** for users who are just starting their careers. Additionally, there is little to no emphasis on learning support, mentorship, or performance feedback, making it difficult for students and emerging professionals to gain meaningful experience.

Similarly, **internship portals** like *Internshala* and *Glassdoor* focus mainly on academic training opportunities for students and recent graduates. Though they effectively help bridge the gap between academia and industry, these systems often lack **advanced project tracking**, **real-time communication**, and **progress analytics**. Once an internship begins, most portals provide minimal support for collaboration or monitoring. As a result, organizations face difficulties in evaluating intern performance, while students lose out on structured guidance and transparent progress reporting.

In addition to these, **networking platforms** such as *LinkedIn* facilitate professional connections and career development but do not integrate **project management** or **internship monitoring** features. Users can connect, communicate, and showcase their skills, but they cannot manage ongoing projects or internships through the same interface. Academic studies further support the need for integrated systems combining these functionalities. Research in **Human-Computer Interaction (HCI)** emphasizes **user-centered design** for improved usability and engagement, while studies in **Software Engineering** advocate for **three-tier architecture** to ensure scalability, reliability, and efficient system performance. These insights collectively highlight the necessity for a unified **Freelance and Internship Platform** that bridges the gap between academia and industry by combining communication, analytics, and management tools within a single ecosystem.

2.2 Limitation Existing system or research gap

- Lack of integration between freelancing and internships.
- Absence of role-based dashboards tailored for different stakeholders.
- Limited or no real-time communication and collaboration tools.
- Poor support for analytics and progress visualization.
- Inadequate administrator monitoring for transparency and security.

The research gap shows that no single platform integrates freelancing and internships while addressing communication, tracking, and analytics. This project aims to fill this gap.

Chapter 3 Proposed System

3.1 Process Model (Agile Model)



The proposed **Freelance and Internship Platform** is developed using the **Agile Software Development Model**, which emphasizes iterative progress, flexibility, and continuous stakeholder involvement. Agile methodology breaks the project into smaller development cycles known as **sprints**, each delivering a functional component of the system. This approach ensures that the platform evolves incrementally with every sprint, incorporating feedback and improvements along the way. Agile is well-suited for projects like this, where requirements may evolve based on user interaction, testing results, or technological advancements.

The Agile model begins with **requirement gathering and analysis**, where key features such as dashboards, authentication, communication modules, and analytics tools are identified. These requirements are documented as **user stories** in the product backlog. During **sprint planning**, a subset of these stories is selected for development in the next iteration. Each sprint typically lasts two to four weeks, during which the team performs **design, development, testing, and integration** activities.

Daily **scrum meetings** are conducted to ensure clear communication, identify obstacles, and track progress. After completing each sprint, a **review session** is held with stakeholders to demonstrate the working module and collect feedback. Any required modifications are added to the backlog for subsequent iterations. This continuous loop of development, testing, and feedback ensures that the final system is user-centered, adaptable, and of high quality.

By following the **Agile approach**, the **Freelance and Internship Platform** ensures that user expectations are consistently met, risks are minimized, and improvements are made continuously. The result is a scalable, transparent, and efficient system that evolves in alignment with both academic and industrial requirements. Agile's emphasis on teamwork, adaptability, and communication perfectly aligns with the project's goal of bridging the gap between academia and industry through technology.

3.2 Proposed Methodology / Architecture

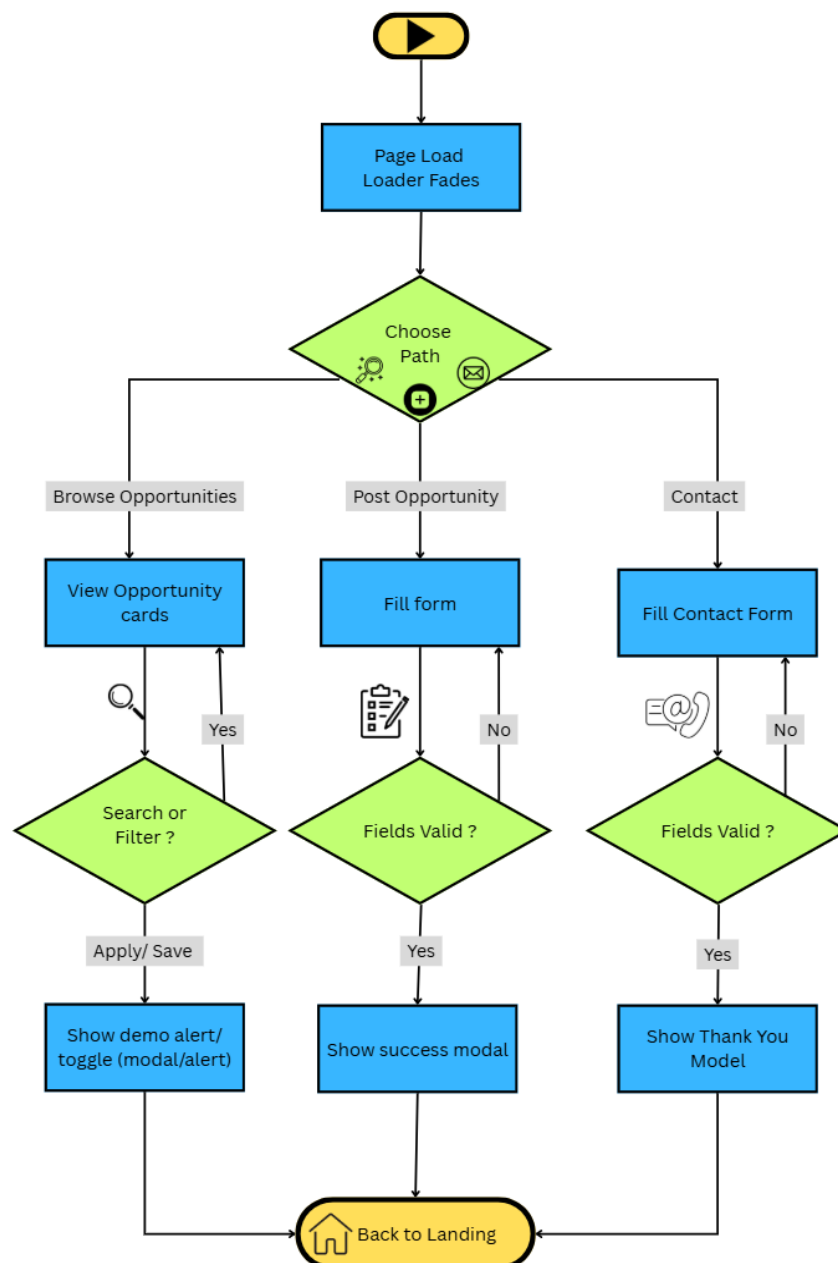
The system is developed using a three-tier architecture:

- Presentation Layer (Frontend): HTML, CSS, JavaScript/React.js for UI.
- Application Layer (Backend): Node.js/Django for business logic.
- Database Layer: MySQL/MongoDB for storing user and project data.

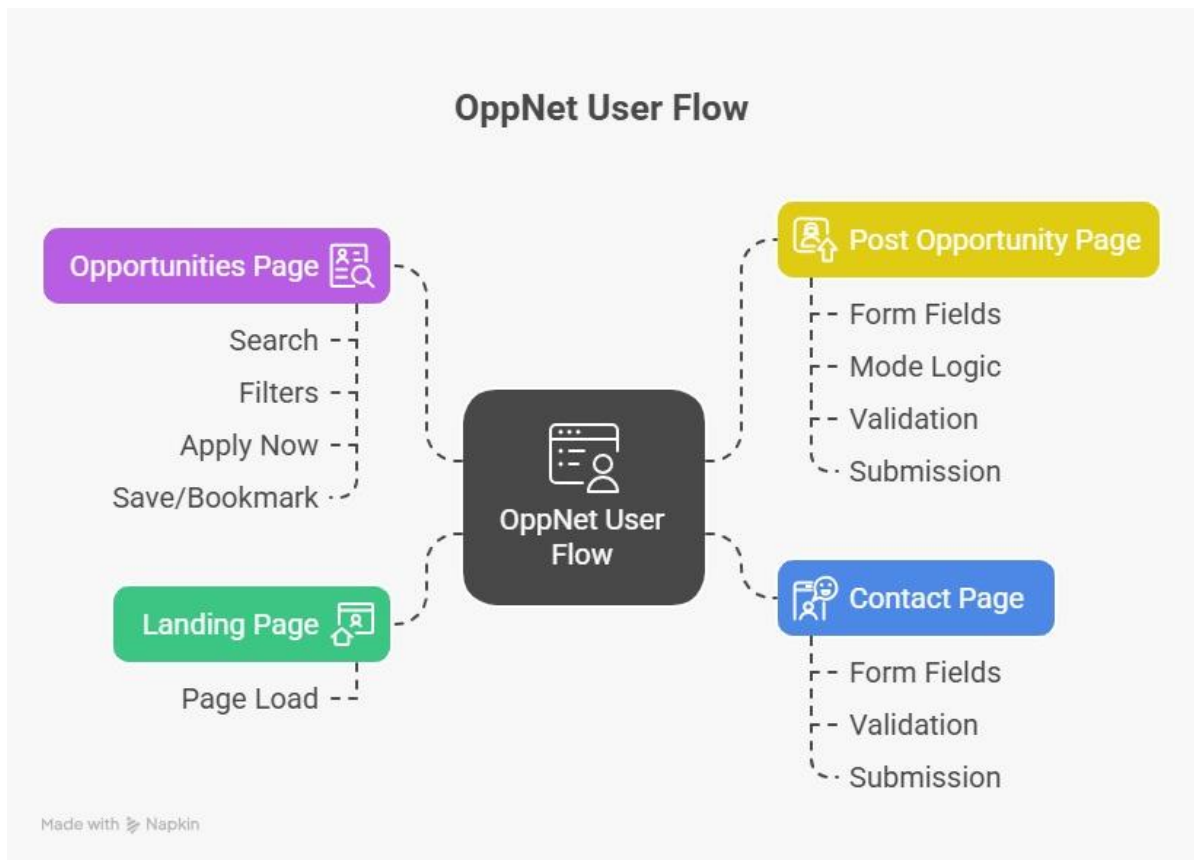
External services such as authentication APIs, notification systems, and optional payment gateways are integrated for enhanced functionality.

3.3 UML diagrams

Flowchart



User Flow Diagram



3.4 Details of Hardware and Software

Hardware Requirements:

- Minimum 4 GB RAM, 1.8 GHz processor, 500 GB storage.

Software Requirements:

- Operating System: Windows/Linux
- Frontend: HTML, CSS, JavaScript/React.js
- Backend: Node.js/Django
- Database: MySQL/MongoDB
- Tools: Visual Studio Code, Git, GitHub, UML design tools

3.5 Use of Metrics to estimate the cost

The cost is estimated using metrics such as Lines of Code (LOC), Function Point Analysis (FPA), and COCOMO model. Agile methodology also helps track development cost through iterative sprints and workload distribution. Metrics consider hardware resources, software tools, development time, and manpower.

Chapter 4 Conclusion and Future work

The Freelance and Internship Platform represents a transformative solution that unifies two distinct yet complementary domains—freelancing and internships—into a single integrated system. Traditional platforms have long treated these areas separately, limiting collaboration and creating inefficiencies in managing opportunities, applications, and communication. The proposed system bridges this gap by providing a centralized hub where students, freelancers, organizations, and administrators can interact seamlessly. With features such as role-based dashboards, secure authentication, real-time communication tools, application tracking, and data-driven analytics, the platform ensures transparency, usability, and efficiency for all stakeholders involved.

Through its structured and intuitive interface, the platform empowers students to explore real-world projects, gain practical exposure, and enhance their employability. Freelancers can showcase their skills, collaborate with clients, and manage multiple assignments efficiently. Simultaneously, organizations benefit from a unified system for recruiting, evaluating, and managing both interns and freelancers. Administrators, on the other hand, can monitor user activity, maintain data integrity, and ensure smooth platform operations. Overall, the system promotes collaboration between academia and industry, encouraging experiential learning and professional growth.

Looking ahead, the platform has significant potential for further enhancement and scalability. Future developments could include the integration of payment gateways to facilitate secure financial transactions between freelancers and clients, ensuring a complete workflow within the system. Incorporating AI-based recommendation algorithms will enable personalized opportunity suggestions based on user skills, experience, and interests. Additionally, blockchain-based verification mechanisms can be implemented to authenticate credentials, prevent fraud, and ensure transparency in user profiles and project histories.

Another vital enhancement would be the development of a mobile application, which would make the platform more accessible and convenient, allowing users to manage tasks, communicate, and apply for opportunities anytime, anywhere. Moreover, expanding the platform's reach to support global users will foster cross-border collaboration, enabling institutions and industries worldwide to connect through a unified digital ecosystem.

In conclusion, the Freelance and Internship Platform not only addresses current challenges in managing internships and freelance opportunities but also lays the foundation for a sustainable, scalable, and intelligent ecosystem. With continuous innovation and integration of emerging technologies, it has the potential to become a global bridge between academia and industry, empowering individuals to learn, work, and grow in the evolving digital landscape.